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Hardware Requests, Asset Management and Returns

New equipment requests, replacements, loaners, asset records and disposal

Default priority: P4 Low (P3 if the user has no working device)

Target response / resolution: Respond in 30 min / fulfil in 3 business days

Handled by: Tier 2 / Asset team

Scope

Use this instruction for requests for new or replacement hardware, loaner devices, accessories, asset moves, returns, and disposal. Accurate asset records are the basis for security, support, and audit.

Related instructions: WI-03 Laptops and Peripherals, WI-02 Onboarding, WI-17 Offboarding

Common symptoms

- User needs a new laptop, monitor, phone, or accessory
- Device is due for replacement or beyond repair
- Equipment is moving between users or locations
- Device returned by a leaver or an unused device found
- Asset record does not match the device in use

Information to collect

- User, department, cost centre, and manager approval
- Equipment needed, quantity, and business reason
- Required date, and location for delivery
- Asset tag, serial number, and current user for replacements and returns

Resolution steps

- 1 Check the standard.** Compare the request with the hardware standard for the role. Standard items can be approved by the manager. Non-standard items need further approval and a business case.
- 2 Check stock and warranty.** Look in stock for suitable equipment before ordering. For a replacement, check the warranty status and whether a repair is possible.
- 3 Get approvals and raise the order.** Attach the manager's approval and the cost centre. Raise a purchase request if stock is not available, and tell the user the expected delivery time.
- 4 Prepare the equipment.** Image and enrol the device, install the standard software, apply encryption and security policies, and label it with the asset tag.
- 5 Deliver and hand over.** Hand the device to the user, check their identity, and record the handover. Show them how to sign in and where to get help. Get a signature or an electronic acknowledgement.
- 6 Update the asset register.** Record the serial number, asset tag, user, location, status, and purchase and warranty dates. Mark old devices as returned or pending disposal.
- 7 Process returns and disposal.** Collect old equipment, back up data if needed, securely wipe the drive, and record the wipe. Dispose of or recycle through the approved supplier and keep the certificate.

Escalate when

- Request exceeds the budget or the hardware standard
- Equipment is lost, stolen, or not returned (see WI-10)
- Stock levels are too low to meet demand

Resolution and closure

- Update the asset register and attach the handover record
- Attach the data wipe or disposal certificate for returned equipment
- Close after the user has confirmed receipt and the device works

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
User asks for a second monitor	Standard accessory request	Check the standard, get manager approval, and issue from stock.
Laptop is four years old and failing	End of life	Check the refresh policy, approve a replacement, and arrange data migration.
Asset register shows the wrong user	Handover not recorded	Verify the serial number with the user and correct the record.
Returned device found in a cupboard	Untracked equipment	Identify through the serial number, wipe it, and update the register.
Urgent replacement after loss	Lost or stolen device	Issue a loaner, block the lost device, and raise a security incident.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	"I can help with that. What do you need the equipment for, and when do you need it by?"
During	"I have asked your manager to approve this. Once they do, I will prepare the laptop and let you know when you can collect it."
Close	"Here is your new device. Please sign in now while I am here, and keep the old one safe until we collect it."

Good practice

Do

- Keep the asset register accurate and current
- Record serial numbers at every handover
- Wipe devices before reuse or disposal
- Use approved disposal suppliers

Do not

- Do not hand over equipment without recording it
- Do not store unwiped devices in open cupboards
- Do not order outside the approved suppliers
- Do not leave loaners unrecorded

Worked example

A manager requests a replacement laptop for a team member whose device keeps failing.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	Laptop (4 years old) fails repeatedly. Needs replacement this week.
Checks performed	Device is out of warranty. Refresh policy allows replacement at 4 years.
Cause	End of device life.
Action taken	Approved. Prepared a standard laptop from stock, migrated data, and collected the old device for wiping.
Result	New laptop handed over. Register updated. Old device wiped and recycled.

Analyst checklist

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| ☐ Check the standard | ☐ Update the asset register |
| ☐ Check stock and warranty | ☐ Process returns and disposal |
| ☐ Get approvals and raise the order | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Prepare the equipment | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Deliver and hand over | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Plan a hardware refresh cycle and budget
- Run a yearly physical audit against the register
- Keep a buffer stock of the most-used models
- Use asset tags and barcode scanning